It is the *gees* of the policeman who lives to protect his community, the *gees* of the teacher who lives to educate children, the *gees* of the doctors and nurses who live to heal the sick, the *gees* of the businessman who creates wealth and jobs; it is even the *gees* of the occasional honest politician who wants to improve lives.

It is also the *gees* of a national team that gives everything – absolutely everything – on the field, that always works hard and never gives up under any circumstances, that simply strives to make people proud.

It is this *gees* that makes our country special. It is this *gees* that makes me feel so privileged to go to work, both at home and around the world, with the words 'South Africa' on my chest.

Make no mistake, it is impossible for me to exaggerate the surge of pure and unequivocal excitement that I feel every time I arrive back in South Africa after spending a few weeks or months abroad. It is home, of course, but there is something more, something more that touches me in the most profound way.

Many people have crafted words and music to explain the essence of this amazing, mysterious place, and most of them seem to come from other countries!

> *It's gonna take a lot to drag me away from you*
> *There's nothing that a hundred men or more could ever do*
> *I bless the rains down in Africa*
> *Gonna take some time to do the things we never had*

The well-known chorus of 'Africa' is fantastic, but it is sung by Toto, a US rock band, and the lyrics were written by American David Paich, who was so moved by watching an early 1980s documentary about pain and suffering in Africa that he created a song about what he would do *if* he was there.